COMMITTEE DIRECTOR'S COMPLETE SCRIPT

UNGA

Opening Speech & Roll Call

10 minutes total | 45 delegations | Opening session

Run of Show

Time	Activity	Duration
0:00–2:00	Opening Speech	2 minutes
2:00–2:45	Executive Board Introduction	45 seconds
2:45–8:45	Roll Call (45 countries)	6 minutes
8:45–9:30	Attendance Confirmation	45 seconds
9:30–10:00	Transition to Next Agenda Item	30 seconds

01 · Opening Speech 0:00–2:00

CD · DELIVER WARMLY AND DELIBERATELY

"Honourable delegates, distinguished representatives, respected faculty members, and members of the Executive Board, a very good morning to everyone.

It is my pleasure to welcome you all to the United Nations General Assembly.

Today, you are representing different nations, each with its own interests, policies, challenges, and perspectives. As delegates, your responsibility is not only to present your country's position but also to listen, negotiate, cooperate, and work towards meaningful solutions.

The United Nations is built upon the principles of diplomacy, international cooperation, mutual respect, and peaceful dialogue. I expect all delegates to reflect these principles throughout today's proceedings.

I encourage you to participate confidently, present well-researched arguments, respect opposing viewpoints, and maintain diplomatic decorum.

Remember, the objective of this committee is not simply to win an argument, but to engage in constructive debate and achieve practical outcomes.

On behalf of the Executive Board, I wish you all an engaging, productive, and successful committee session.

Thank you."

02 · Executive Board Introduction 2:00–2:45

CD

"Before proceeding with the formal proceedings, allow me to introduce the Executive Board.

I am **[YOUR NAME]**, and I will be serving as your Committee Director for this session.

Alongside me is **[ACD NAME]**, who will be serving as your Assistant Committee Director.

We will be responsible for facilitating debate, maintaining order, ensuring fair participation, and guiding the committee through its proceedings.

I hereby call the United Nations General Assembly to order."

03 · Roll Call 2:45–8:45

CD · INSTRUCTIONS TO DELEGATES

"We shall now proceed with the roll call. I request all delegates to remain attentive.

When your country's name is called, kindly raise your placard and respond clearly with either 'Present' or 'Present and Voting', in accordance with the Rules of Procedure."

How to conduct the roll call

1. Call countries alphabetically using your official country list.
2. Allow approximately 7–8 seconds per country.
3. Wait for the delegate to raise their placard and respond.
4. Your ACD should mark attendance immediately.
5. Do not stop to discuss a delegate's response.

Example dialogue

CD: “Afghanistan.”
Delegate: “Present.”

CD: “Albania.”
Delegate: “Present and Voting.”

CD: “Algeria.”
Delegate: “Present.”

Continue in the same manner until all 45 countries have been called.

If a delegate does not respond
CD: “The delegation of **[COUNTRY]**, please indicate your presence.”
If there is still no response, mark the delegation absent for now and continue.

04 · Attendance Confirmation 8:45–9:30

Once all 45 countries have been called, ask your ACD for the attendance count.

CD

“Thank you, delegates. The roll call has been completed.

According to the attendance recorded by the Assistant Committee Director, **[NUMBER]** delegations are present, while **[NUMBER]** delegations are absent.

The Executive Board confirms that **[QUORUM STATUS, ACCORDING TO THE RULES OF PROCEDURE]**.”

05 · Transition to Next Agenda Item 9:30–10:00

CD

“Having completed the opening formalities and roll call, we shall now proceed to the introduction of the agenda and the Rules of Procedure.

I request all delegates to remain attentive as we move forward with today's proceedings.

Thank you, delegates.”

PRESIDING OFFICER'S REFERENCE

Executive Board Checklist

Committee Director (CD)

Your responsibilities:

- Deliver the opening speech.
- Introduce the Executive Board.
- Call all 45 countries during roll call.
- Maintain a steady pace.
- Keep the committee attentive and disciplined.
- Announce the attendance result.
- Transition smoothly to the next agenda item.

Assistant Committee Director (ACD)

Your responsibilities:

- Maintain the official attendance sheet.
- Record "Present" and "Present and Voting" separately.
- Count the delegates present.
- Inform the CD of the quorum status.
- Signal the CD if the session is running behind schedule.
- Keep an accurate record of absent delegations.

Timing Tips

- Do not allow unnecessary applause or conversations between country names.
- Avoid lengthy pauses during roll call.
- Keep the country list in front of you in alphabetical order.
- Coordinate with your ACD before the session begins.
- Keep the roll call formal, clear, and continuous.
- If a delegate is unresponsive, do not waste excessive time; follow the conference's attendance procedure.

Remember: With 45 delegates, every few seconds matter. Your objective is to establish authority, create a professional atmosphere, and complete the opening formalities within the allotted 10 minutes.

Final Reminder

Speak slowly during the opening speech, **clearly** during roll call, and **confidently** when addressing the committee.

You are the presiding officer. Stay neutral, remain composed, and keep the proceedings moving.